

the syncretisms of later Christianity, which cast its net into many waters and gathered of many kinds, both bad and good.

I cannot state my text better than by quoting a page from Prof. Bousset's well-known work on Judaism in New Testament times.¹ The author is a leader among those who believe in a definite and powerful influence exerted upon Judaism and early Christianity by Parsi thought. I shall have to argue against this view, except to a very limited extent, but the passage will serve none the worse as a statement of the common features of the religions, however explained :

In the Persian religion the later Judaism came in contact with a powerful and influential faith, predominant in one part of the world and strongly impressing even the Greeks, which at least in its purer form was almost of equal rank with itself. In no other religion outside Judaism was there so pronounced and triumphant a movement of belief towards monotheism—if we make allowance for the strong tendency to dualism. Ahura Mazdah is, among all the deities of the world that surrounded Judaism, distinctively of a type which can most easily be compared with that of Yahweh. We have here also a strong spiritualising, transcendental bent, a deep-seated union of religion with earnest ethical thought. And in details how many resemblances and agreements are found! Here, as there, the thought of the hereafter and the judgement is central, and the doctrine of individual rewards and punishments is complementary to apocalyptic, the elaborated doctrine of the future of the world. In both religions there is a tendency towards dualism: the Kingdom of God, of Ahura Mazdah, stands in contrast with that of the devil, of Angra Mainyu. In both we find remarkable coincidences in

¹ *Die Religion des Judentums in neutestamentlichen Zeitalter*, ed.² (1906), p. 549.